

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Chicago's pope

ROBERT PREVOST ELECTED FIRST AMERICAN PONTIFF, TAKES NAME LEO XIV



Newly elected Pope Leo XIV appears on the balcony of St. Peter's Basilica at the Vatican on Thursday. ALESSANDRA TARANTINO/AP

Prevost was 'the pride and joy of every priest and nun' at St. Mary's

By Angie Leventis Lourgos, Gregory Royal Pratt, Carolyn Stein, Olivia Stevens, Jeremy Gerner, Caroline Kubzansky, Samantha Moilanen and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

Catholics across the region celebrated the historic announcement Thursday that the first American pope in the 2,000-year history of the church was born and raised in the Chicago area and marveled that the faithful will now be led by a relatable

local boy who grew up in the south suburbs, cheers for the White Sox and hits up Aurelio's pizza when he comes back home.

In his first words as Pope Leo XIV, 69-year-old Robert Francis Prevost proclaimed "peace be with you," invoking a message of dialogue, unity and care for those in need from Vatican City.

"When I heard the news of the new Holy Father at that moment, at least here in Chicago, the sun came out,"

Turn to Prevost, Page 4

Emphasizes peace, dialogue, missionary evangelization in initial message

By Nicole Winfield
Associated Press

VATICAN CITY — Robert Prevost, the Chicago-born missionary who spent his career ministering in Peru and took over the Vatican's powerful office of bishops, was elected the first pope from the United States in the history of the Catholic Church.

Prevost, a 69-year-old member of the Augustinian religious order, took the name Leo XIV.

In his first words as Pope Francis' successor, uttered from the loggia of

St. Peter's Basilica, Leo said, "Peace be with you," and emphasized a message of peace, dialogue and missionary evangelization. He wore the traditional red cape of the papacy — a cape that Francis had eschewed on his election in 2013 — suggesting a return to some degree of tradition after Francis' unorthodox pontificate.

Prevost had been a leading candidate for the papacy, but there had long been a taboo against a U.S. pope, given the country's geopolitical power

Turn to Pope, Page 5

Chicago school board president talks cuts, uncertainty

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

When school board President Sean Harden met with principals earlier this week as part of an ongoing effort to emphasize transparency and inclusivity, he was candid.

"Can we win the lottery?" he joked. "I'm being facetious, but I'm being real."

The roundtable discussion

Tuesday evening was hosted by the Chicago Principals and Administrators Association at Peterson Elementary in North Park. School leaders from Edgewater to Austin raised concerns about the impact of leadership changes, the need for equitable resource allocation and budget delays.

Harden was not shy about directly addressing Chicago Public Schools' \$529 million

cash crunch, saying he wants community input while making tough decisions about cuts for the upcoming school year. Despite extensive unknowns looming in the months and years ahead, he remained positive.

Typically, school-level budgets are released between March and May to ensure that principals, local school councils and school communities have sufficient time to plan. A newly expanded,

21-member school board has pushed back the release of those budgets, which Harden attributed Tuesday to the district's fiscal challenges but also to the growing pains with a governing body three times the size of the previous seven-member board.

"It's painful, to be honest, but it's also what the public wanted in a democratically elected school

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TODAY'S WEATHER

High **64**
Low **49**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

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